to this also factors such as nutrition, drinking water, healthcare, education, shelter, social welfare and social security measures, etc. are given due care. The implementation of the social sector related areas in an integrated manner is supposed to have an inherent impact on the matter of population control.[7]

The National Health Policy of 2002 and the priorities set in the successive Five year Plans provide the framework for the implementation of policies and programmes for health care. The National Health Policy seeks to provide prophylactic and curative health-care services and aims at achieving an acceptable standard of good health amongst the general population in the country by increasing access to the decentralised public health system.

Access to the decentralised public health system is sought to be increased through establishment of new infrastructure in deficient areas and upgrading of existing infrastructure. Success in eliminating or controlling diseases such as small pox, leprosy, polio, and TB is indicative of the progress made in some areas of health. Overall sex ratio in the country has increased from 933 in 2001 to 940 as per **Census 2011**. Despite progress made on many fronts, there are areas of concern as progress has been quite uneven across regions with large-scale inter-state variations and rural and remote areas continue to have deficit in health facilities and manpower.

HUNGaMA Survey[8]

A reduction in the prevalence of child malnutrition is observed: Prevalence of child underweight has decreased from 53 per cent to 42 per cent; this represents a 20.3 per cent decrease over a 7 year period with an average annual rate of reduction of 2.9 per cent.

Child malnutrition is widespread across states and districts and starts early in life: 42 per cent of children under five are underweight and 59 per cent are stunted. Of the children suffering from stunting, about half are severely stunted; about half of all children are underweight or stunted by age 24 months.

Birth weight is an important risk-factor for child malnutrition: Prevalence of underweight in children born with a weight below 2.5 kg is